# Hassan Sharief Noor

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**Hassan Sharief Noor**



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| **Full Name** | Hassan Sharief Noor |
| **BirthPlace** | Punud-Taporog, Poona Bayabao, Lanao del Sur |
| **Born** | January 15, 1942 |
| **Ethnicity** | Maranao |
| **Religion** | Islam |
| **Known for** | First Filipino Muslim World Qur'an Reading champion |

# Hassan Sharief Noor

**Ustadz Hassan Sharief Noor** (born January 15, 1942) is a Filipino Muslim Qur'an reader (*qari*), educator, and Islamic scholar from Punud-Taporog, Poona Bayabao, Lanao del Sur. He is widely recognized as a pioneer of Qur'anic recitation in the Philippines and the first Filipino Muslim to win an international Qur'an reading competition, bringing global recognition to Filipino Muslim scholarship.

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## Early Life and Education

- Hassan Sharief Noor was born on January 15, 1942, in Punud-Taporog, Poona Bayabao, Lanao del Sur.
- He was raised in a religious household, where his father, an Arabic teacher, trained him in Qur'anic reading at an early age.
- He completed his elementary education at Talagian Elementary School, where he studied alongside future Lanao del Sur governor Dr. Mahid Mutilan.

- He later pursued higher education at Jamiatul Philippine Al-Islamiah in Marawi City, where he earned a Bachelor of Science in Education.

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## Teaching Career

- Noor began his professional career as a public school teacher at Talagian Elementary School in Poona Bayabao, serving from 1962 to 1980.
- He subsequently joined Jamiatul Philippine Al-Islamiah as an instructor from 1981 to 1987.

- From 1987 to 2008, he served at the Mindanao State University – King Faisal Center for Islamic, Arabic and Asian Studies in Marawi City, where he:

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- Taught basic Arabic subjects
- Served as Director for Extension Services
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- Beyond formal institutions, he taught Qur'anic recitation continuously from 1971 to 2015, mentoring generations of students in proper pronunciation (*tajwid*) and recitation techniques.

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# Qur'an Recitation and International Recognition

- Ustadz Noor gained national and international recognition for his excellence in Qur'anic recitation, known for:

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- A melodious and disciplined voice
- Mastery of correct Arabic pronunciation (tajwid)
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- In September 1979, he became the **first Filipino Muslim champion** in an International Qur'an Reading Competition held in Tripoli, Libya.
- This achievement marked a historic milestone, demonstrating that Filipino Muslims could compete at the highest level in Islamic scholarship and recitation.
- His victory drew attention from Muslim countries, many of which were previously unaware of the depth of Islamic learning in the Philippines.

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# Role as International Judge

- Due to his expertise and reputation, Noor was invited to serve as a **hakam** (judge) in international Qur'an reading competitions held in Bangkok, Thailand in:

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- 1991
- 1993
- 2000
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- His participation as a judge reflects his standing in the global Qur'anic recitation community.

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# Legacy and Influence

- Ustadz Hassan Sharief Noor is regarded as one of the key figures in the development of Qur'anic recitation in the Philippines.
- He trained numerous students who later excelled in national and international competitions, including:

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- Abdul Basit Tomara
- Isnairah Bantayao
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- His lifelong dedication to teaching helped sustain and strengthen the tradition of Qur'an reading among Muslim Filipinos.

- He is widely considered one of the reasons why Qur’anic recitation remains vibrant and active in the Bangsamoro community.

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## Significance

- Noor’s achievements elevated the profile of Filipino Muslims in the global Islamic community.
- He bridged traditional Islamic learning and modern educational institutions in the Philippines.
- His contributions continue to influence Islamic education, particularly in Qur’anic studies, in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao.

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## See Also

- Qur'an
- Madrasah
- Islam in the Philippines
- Mindanao State University
- Bangsamoro identity

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